

Storage Options

Older models of cameras have inbuilt fixed storage, which can't be modified easily—this inhibits the number of photos you can click before erasing them to make space for new ones. Most modern digicams use flash memory cards, small hard disks, CDs and sometimes even floppy disks.

The number of images that you can store in a digicam depends on Storage capacity of the device (in MB), resolution at which the photographs are clicked, amount of compression used to reduce the file size.

Flash Card Storage

Flash memory chips (similar to the RAM chips used inside our PCs) don't require batteries, take up very little space and can retain photographs indefinitely without any power supply to the flash memory components. These chips are packaged inside a special case, which is equipped with electrical connectors. However, memory chips come in a variety of formats, which are specific to certain camera models. The different formats currently available in the market are PC Cards, CompactFlash, SmartMedia, MemorySticks and x-Picture Cards



Flash memory cards are a great way to store digital images over long periods of time

Hard Disk Storage

Devices like IBM's Microdrive hard disk drives help store outputs from high resolution cameras. Some of these drives can also be plugged into a Type II CompactFlash slot on a digicam or flash card